BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #52 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

"My worth depends on how I look."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Constant evaluation of faces and bodies, by media, peers, and ourselves, can make appearance the basis of identity. Aging and change then threaten our worth itself.

What Scripture teaches

"You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor." "God created man in His own image." "Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised" (Proverbs 31:30). Worth is established by God's creation and love, not by looks. Appearance is one small part of a person.

> *"Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised"* (Proverbs 31:30).

Also see

> "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor" (Psalm 8:5).

> "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them" (Genesis 1:27).

> "Your beauty should not come from outward adornment, such as braided hair or gold jewelry or fine clothes, but from the inner disposition of your heart, the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is precious in God's sight" (1 Peter 3:3–4).

> "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us" (Romans 5:8).

Common self-statements

- I am my appearance.
- If I look bad, I am worthless.
- I need to look good to matter.
- Aging will take my value.
- I check mirrors constantly.
- I cannot go out without makeup.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either attractive and valuable or not.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that aging will ruin my worth.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling bad about my looks and concluding I am worthless.
- Labeling: Calling myself my appearance.

Challenging questions

- What part of my worth do I tie to my looks?
- What do I admire in others besides their looks?
- What happens when I skip checking the mirror?

- What did God declare about humanity in Genesis?
- What could I do to care for myself without obsession?
- What matters most to me at the end of life?

Truth summary

> My worth rests in God's creation, love, and calling, not in my looks. I can care for myself with gratitude and move my attention to what lasts.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Worldly
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- God, Creator

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My worth depends on how I look"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My worth depends on how I look." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What part of my worth do I tie to my looks?
- ☐ What do I admire in others besides their looks?
- ☐ What happens when I skip checking the mirror?
- ☐ What did God declare about humanity in Genesis?
- ☐ What could I do to care for myself without obsession?
- ☐ What matters most to me at the end of life?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am crowned with glory and honor.
- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ Beauty is fleeting.
- ☐ God loves me as I am.
- ☐ I can care for myself kindly.
- ☐ What lasts is character.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 31:30**
  "Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised."
- ☐ **Psalm 8:5**
  "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor."
- ☐ **Genesis 1:27**
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Worth beyond looks: Each week, note one thing you did that had nothing to do with appearance.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 31:30 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am crowned with glory and honor.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Notice the habit. Count how often you check the mirror.
- [ ] Limit it. Reduce one checking habit.
- [ ] Build something lasting. Invest in a skill or kindness.
- [ ] Read Proverbs 31:30. Remember what lasts.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My worth depends on how I look": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Worth beyond looks
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My worth depends on how I look.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have tied my worth to my looks. Free me, teach me to see myself as You do, and help me invest in what lasts. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.